A heat map in Tableau is more beneficial than a traditional bar chart when we need to compare multiple categories and identify patterns using colors.

Example scenario: Insurance Data Analysis

Suppose we want to analyze the total claim amount by Gender and Incident Severity.

- **Heat Map:** Place Gender on Columns, Incident Severity on Rows, and Total Claim Amount on Color. Darker colors can represent higher claim amounts, while lighter colors represent lower amounts.
- **Bar Chart**: It can compare claim amounts across categories, but comparing many combinations may require multiple bars and make the chart crowded.

How a heat map improves decision-making:

1. **Quick pattern recognition:** Easily identifies which gender and incident severity combination has the highest claims.
2. **Identifies unusual values:** Highlights categories with unexpectedly high or low claim amounts.
3. **Better resource allocation**: Helps insurance companies investigate high-claim categories and plan their risk-management strategies.
4. **Saves time:** Decision-makers can identify important trends without examining every individual value.

Conclusion: A heat map is best for identifying patterns across multiple dimensions, whereas a bar chart is generally better for precise comparisons between individual categories.